

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

An amazing coincidence.



Learning Outcome

Describe unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever experienced something which you can not explain, or a strange coincidence? If so, what was it?
- Do you believe in déjà vu?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences and strange events.
- I can write about past events.
- I can discuss experiences I have and haven't had.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa worked all day, so she is completely **wiped out***

* "Wiped out" means to be very tired.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Sally: Well, Google hasn't heard of this story either, so I think it might be bogus. I haven't checked the Internet for strange stories yet, maybe they have some peculiar ones.

Vanessa: I'm sure it will.

Sally: Oh, here's a good one. Have you heard of this one?

Vanessa: Which one?

Sally: This one from England. It is such a strange coincidence.

Vanessa: Read it to me. I'm too worn out to get up.

Sally: This story was written in 2001. A girl named Laura Buxton released a helium filled balloon at her grandparents' gold wedding anniversary. Her name and address were attached to the balloon along with a note asking the finder to write back.

Vanessa: Wow.

Sally: A reply was received ten days later saying the balloon had been found by another Laura Buxton in the garden of her home 140 miles away.

Vanessa: Yep. That sounds awesome.

Sally: The Lauras were both aged ten and they both had the same pets. They both had a three year old black Labrador and ...

Vanessa: Sorry Sally. I need to go home. I am wiped out.

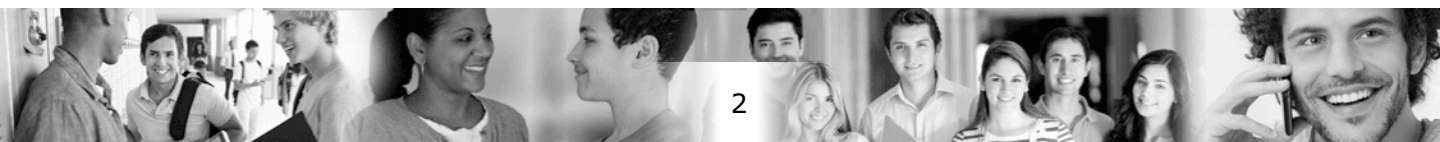
Sally: Of course. What are you doing tomorrow?

Vanessa: I want to see a movie. Have you seen the new Jennifer Aniston flick?

Sally: Yeah, I saw it on Tuesday. It's good. How about a late lunch?

Vanessa: Done. Have fun writing.

Sally: Bye.





Let's Practice!

Let's see if you can find them!

Instructions: Find the words in the word search below.

1. named
2. checked
3. heard
4. wiped out
5. worn out

C	L	D	P	P	R	S	A	I	Q	X	Q	Q	J	F
T	Q	I	T	W	I	P	E	O	U	T	Q	W	U	R
Z	X	S	T	U	E	O	V	H	R	H	E	K	G	R
R	H	P	X	L	A	L	N	B	T	G	S	C	V	W
V	E	N	H	T	X	L	M	V	D	Y	I	H	R	O
E	Q	N	A	K	W	E	E	A	O	U	U	E	G	R
L	O	S	J	M	R	N	U	Q	A	C	R	A	A	N
J	C	E	S	P	E	C	P	L	D	T	B	R	G	O
V	Z	R	F	S	V	D	V	V	B	S	I	D	E	U
D	M	B	U	Z	M	W	J	G	V	K	D	T	Y	T
S	K	P	M	R	Y	G	R	E	K	R	G	T	C	K
W	E	L	E	V	A	T	E	Y	O	V	Y	Z	J	X
K	M	R	C	H	E	C	K	E	D	B	Q	H	F	K
U	U	A	D	C	O	I	D	D	V	Q	O	Z	O	B
W	X	M	O	Y	S	W	E	L	L	I	N	G	V	G



Let's Practice!

Here's a little bit about Sally's story.

Instructions: Complete the sentences by choosing from the words below.

is write / was written / were written / were attached / were attach /
was attached / is receive / was received / were received / had be
found / had been find / had been found.

1. This story _____ in 2001.
2. Her name and address _____ to the balloon.
3. A reply _____ ten days later.
4. The balloon _____ by another Laura Buxton.
5. The story _____ by Sally.





Extension Activity

A déjà vu role play!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm various types of coincidence and déjà vu.
- Write a dialogue with a partner about a time you experienced déjà vu or a strange coincidence.
- Make your dialogue 8-10 lines long.
- Act out your dialogue for your class.

Self-Assessment

Yes
No

I can talk about coincidences and strange events.

☐ ☐

I can write about past events.

☐ ☐

I can discuss experiences I have and haven't had.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **bogus** (adjective): not real, although pretending to be real
e.g. Google hasn't heard of this story either, so I think it might be bogus.
- **peculiar** (adjective): strange, often in an unpleasant way
e.g. I haven't checked the Internet for strange stories yet, maybe they have some peculiar ones.
- **to wear out** (verb): to make someone feel very tired
e.g. Read it to me. I'm too worn out to get up.
- **helium** (noun): a gas that is lighter than air, often used for lifting large balloons
e.g. A girl named Laura Buxton released a helium-filled balloon.
- **wiped out** (adjective): extremely tired
e.g. Sorry Sally. I need to go home. I am wiped out.
- **balloon** (noun): a small colored bag of thin rubber that you fill with air, used as a child's toy or a decoration
e.g. A girl named Laura Buxton released a helium-filled balloon.



Learning Points

The Passive Voice

You use the active voice when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.
You use the passive voice when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.

Active sentence = *Children* (subject) **write** *stories* (object).

Passive sentence = *Stories* (subject) **are written** (object).

It is not always necessary to mention the object in a passive sentence.

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the *be* verb followed by the past participle.

The Simple Present passive form is:

am/are/is + past participle

For example:

- *The story **was written** in 1997.*

The Simple Past passive form is:

was/were + past participle

For example:

- *Those stories **were told** by parents and my grandparents.*

Examples:

- *This story was written in 2001.*
- *Her name and address were attached to the balloon.*
- *A reply was received ten days later.*
- *The balloon had been found by another Laura Buxton.*





Learning Points

Present Perfect

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

I have learned English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

He has bought a painting. = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

To emphasize the result of the action, use the simple form.

- *Have you checked the Internet for some good stories?*
- *I've found a lot of good stories that way.*

Examples:

- *Google hasn't heard of this story either.*
- *I haven't checked the Internet for strange stories yet.*
- *Have you heard of this one?*
- *Have you seen the new Jennifer Aniston flick?*

